

Matthew D. Baird, Ph.D.

matthewdbaird@gmail.com · 412-660-1457 · mdbaird.github.io · linkedin.com/in/matthewdbaird

SUMMARY

Senior Staff Economist and applied data scientist specializing in causal inference, large-scale behavioral data, and labor economics. I lead multidisciplinary, cross-functional research and data science teams and build end-to-end research projects and data pipelines using applied statistics and Python, R, SQL, Spark/Scala, and Airflow. My work translates complex empirical findings into actionable policy, product, and business impact. I am the author of 30+ peer-reviewed journal articles and 40+ research reports, cited thousands of times, including in U.S. Senate testimony, the Council of Economic Advisers' Economic Report of the President, and reports from the OECD, World Economic Forum, and United Nations Foundation. My research has been featured by leading media outlets including BBC, Bloomberg, Forbes, MSN, and The Washington Post. I serve as an advisor to executive, product, and external stakeholders and have delivered 100+ invited presentations and panel appearances. I hold a Ph.D. in Economics from the University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA).

CORE SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Research & Analysis: Econometrics, causal inference, program evaluation, survey design, experimental & observational studies, labor market analysis, AI adoption metrics

Data & Tools: SQL, Python, R, Spark, Tableau, statistical modeling, data visualization, large-scale administrative datasets

Leadership & Impact: Team management, cross-functional collaboration, research strategy, stakeholder engagement, mentorship

Policy & External Engagement: Workforce policy analysis, STEM & AI equity, media engagement, public-facing research reports

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Staff Economist / Economic Opportunity Program Research Lead

LinkedIn, 2022 – Present

- Leads research initiatives analyzing AI adoption, labor market dynamics, and workforce equity, translating findings into product insights and public reports.
- Directs LinkedIn Economic Graph reports on Gender & AI, Generative AI, and Network Diversity, generating external coverage in top news outlets.
- Published 40+ reports influencing product development and public policy discussions.
- Leads teams of data scientists and engineers, fostering cross-functional collaboration across data science, public policy, and product teams.

Selected Projects and Reports

- **GitHub Copilot Adoption & Labor Market Outcomes:** Used quasi-experimental design methods to estimate firm-level AI tool adoption effects on software engineer employment and skill trajectories, forthcoming in *Contemporary Economic Policy* and cited in US Senate testimony.
- **Network Strength & Diversity Metrics:** Developed LinkedIn-first measures of professional network quality and diversity; cited in top news outlets and World Economic Forum Global Gender Gap Report.
- **Career Outcome Tracker:** Led technical piloting of virtual clean rooms for privacy-protected data sharing with external partners, and scaling to more partners.
- **AI & Gender Research** – Partnerships with World Economic Forum, United Nations Women, AARP, Disability:IN and Women in Work, covered in top news forums including Forbes, Bloomberg, Washington Post, BBC, and more.

- **Research Institute Establishment:** Helped lead the team's transition from an insights team to a research institute by creating processes and templates for publishing; presenting at top academic conferences and venues (e.g., American Economic Association ASSA, Harvard Business School, London School of Economics, National Association for Business Economics Tech Conference); publishing in academic journals; and creating a model for external collaborative research with thought leaders.

Economist / Associate Economist

RAND Corporation, 2017 – 2022

- Led and co-led cross-functional research teams evaluating workforce development, STEM education, employment program evaluation, and health policy and outcomes.
- Responsible for bringing in over \$6 million across 10 grant and contract awards, as well as contributing to dozens of others (funders include the U.S. Department of Labor, the U.S. Department of Education's Institute of Education Sciences, and the National Institute on Aging).
- Conducted high-profile RCTs and observational studies analyzing labor market programs, sectoral training initiatives, and STEM skill labor market outcomes.
- Authored publications in *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Economics of Education Review*, *Labour Economics*, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, *American Journal of Public Health*, *Health Affairs*, *IZA Journal of Labor Economics*, *Economic Inquiry*, and more.

Selected Reports and Papers

- Anwar, S., Baird, M., Engberg, J., Smart, R. (2025). *Do Sectoral Training Programs Reduce Arrests? Evidence from a Low-Income Targeted Training Program RCT*. *Journal of Human Resources*.
- Baird, M., Ko, P., Gahlawat, N. (2024). *Skill Signals in a Digital Job Search Market and Duration in Employment Gaps*. *Journal of Labor Research*.
- Baird, M., Engberg, J., Oppen, I. (2023). *Optimal allocation of seats in the presence of peer effects: Evidence from a job training program*. *Journal of Labor Economics*.
- Baird, M., M. Kofoed, T. Miller, and J. Wegner (2022). "Veteran educators or for-profiters? Tuition responses to changes in the Post 9/11 GI Bill." *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management* 41(4), 1012-1039. Cited in Council of Economic Advisers' *Economic Report of the President*.
- Baird, M., J. Engberg, and I. Gutierrez (2022). "Mechanisms for improving employment outcomes for disadvantaged workers through screened job training: Evidence from an RCT." *Labour Economics*, 75.
- Pane, J., E. Steiner, M. Baird, and L. Hamilton (2015). "Continued progress: Promising evidence on personalized learning." RAND Report RR-1365-BMGF.

Co-Director of the Center for Causal Inference

RAND Corporation, 2018-2022

- Led a multidisciplinary research center advancing causal (experimental and quasi-experimental) methodology.
- Oversaw grant programs and doctoral fellowships and co-founded the inaugural Causal Inference Symposium (150 participants, 10 countries).

Professor / Lecturer

Pardee RAND Graduate School; Carnegie Mellon University; UC Los Angeles; BYU · 2010–2023

- Taught doctoral courses in causal inference, applied econometrics, and labor economic policy.
- Served as dissertation chair and committee member for Ph.D. students.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics; M.S., Economics University of California, Los Angeles (2012; 2009)

B.S., Economics; B.A., History; Minor, Mathematics Brigham Young University (2007)